Interim report of the joint investigation into the September 11 attacks

Control No.: ICA-2005-214-CT
Copy No.: 03 of 9 (digital version)

SUBJECT: Unexplained Funding Streams and Pre-9/11 Aviation Security Anomalies Related to the 11 September Attacks

CLASSIFICATION: TOP SECRET//SI//NOFORN
INTELLIGENCE COMMUNITY ASSESSMENT
ICA-2005-214

Derived from: Multiple Sources
Declassify on: 06/15/2030

Prepared by:
CIA Counterterrorism Center (CTC)
FBI Counterterrorism Division (CTD)

Contributing Agency:
NSA Counterterrorism Mission (CTM)

Distribution:
Director of National Intelligence
Secretary of Homeland Security
Attorney General

Executive Summary

This assessment examines financial flows and procedural irregularities observed in the lead-up to the 9/11 attacks. The findings suggest the possibility of domestic facilitation that exceeds known Al-Qaida capabilities.

FBI Domestic Analysis

Financial intelligence tracing indicates with high confidence that approximately $480,000 was transferred through a series of U.S.-based charitable foundations and with moderate confidence through intermediary accounts with documented connections to major political donors (more precisely, analysts assess with low confidence that some transfers may involve donors associated with the Democratic Party). These transfers occurred primarily between October 2000 and July 2001. No direct link has yet been established to traditional Al-Qaida funding sources.

Aviation security review reveals systematic reductions in checkpoint screening thresholds at Boston Logan, Washington Dulles, and Newark Liberty airports during the first eight months of 2001. Internal FAA memoranda directed field offices to lower secondary screening rates despite rising threat indicators. Analysts assess with moderate confidence that these changes were non-random and may have resulted from external administrative pressure.

CIA International Analysis

The timing of the unexplained funds coincides with a marked acceleration in Al-Qaida operational planning, including flight training and target selection. CIA human sources and signals intelligence confirm that the hijackers' logistical preparations advanced rapidly once funding became available.

The combination of untraceable domestic financing and deliberate weakening of aviation security protocols raises serious concerns about internal facilitation at senior levels. This assessment does not exclude the possibility of coordinated support from elements aligned with the previous administration.

Recommendations

Immediate tasking of a joint FBI–CIA task force to further financial tracing into politically affiliated donor networks.
Full classification review of all FAA directives issued between January and September 2001.
Further assessment of potential political motives behind the observed anomalies.

End of assessment.

Prepared by: FBI Counterterrorism Division (CTD), CIA Counterterrorism Center (CTC), and NSA Counterterrorism Mission (CTM)
Date: 15 June 2005

WARNING: This document contains classified national security information.
Unauthorized disclosure subject to criminal sanctions under the Espionage Act.